



Scoreboard

SoHo Laser Printers

BRAND	Canon	Canon	Lexmark	Samsung	Samsung	Wipro	Xerox
Model	LBP 2900	LBP 3200	E230	ML-1520P	ML-1710P	WeP 1600	Phaser 3116
Features	17.34	15.12	21.17	14.61	17.38	9.96	11.25
Printing							
Printing technology	Laser	Laser	Laser	Laser	Laser	Laser	Laser
Resolution (dpi x dpi)	600x600	600x600	600x600	600x600	600x600	600x600	600x600
Paper capacity for Default tray	150	250	250	250	250	150	250
Additional paper tray facility	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Dual Side Printing	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Accessories							
Data cable	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓ (Serial)	✓
Power cord	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Detailed User Manual	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗
Troubleshooting guide	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
Quick setup guide	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
Misc features							
Printing Languages Supported	CAPT	PCL6/PS3	PS3/PCL6	GDI	GDI	PCL5e/PS3	NA
OS Support	Win/Linux	Win/Linux	Win/Lin/MAC	Win/Lin/MAC	Win/Lin/MAC	Win/Linux	Win/Linux
LCD Screen (Color/B/W)	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Interface (USB 1.1/2.0/Parallel)	USB 2.0/Parallel	USB 2.0/Parallel	USB 2.0/Parallel	USB 2.0/Parallel	USB 2.0/Parallel	USB 2.0/Parallel	USB 2.0/Parallel
Menu structure							
Ease of use (scale of 5)	No Screen	No Screen	No Screen	No Screen	No Screen	No Screen	No Screen
Toner Duty Cycle (Bundled - No. of Pages)	2000	3000	2500	3000	3000	1200	1000
Toner Duty Cycle (New - No. of Pages)	2000	3000	2500	3000	3000	3000	3000
Networking capabilities (Y/N/Optional)	Optional	Optional	Optional	✗	Optional	✗	✗
Build Quality							
Breakable flaps/moveable parts (Out of 5)	3.75	2	4	4	4	3	3.25
Transport locks/tapes parts (Out of 5)	2.5	2	4	4.25	4.25	4.25	3
Moveable parts in cartridge bay (Out of 5)	4	3	4	4	4	4	4
Performance	23.18	23.29	20.44	19.06	19.45	16.30	20.23
Speed test (Seconds)							
Warm Up Time	6.1	5.2	8	8	10	9.8	5.4
Text print (B/W) Normal	11.33	9.06	12.15	12.11	12.74	14.2	11.82
Text print (B/W) Best	11.4	9.16	12.13	12.36	12.37	24.06	12.58
Combi document- Normal	12.55	12.57	16.8	14.45	15.1	16.22	12.43
Combi document-Best	11.31	10.9	15.81	14.2	12.37	27.69	14.89
Quality Test							
Text quality (Point Size Document - Out of 5)	4	3.25	4	4	4	3	3.75
Image quality (Combi, Normal, Out of 5)							
Text print (B/W)	3.75	3	3	3	3	3	3.5
Resolution of circles on concentric pattern	3	2	3	2	2.75	2.75	2
White text on black background	3.75	2.5	2	1.5	1.5	2.25	1.75
Minimum readable text point size	3.25	2.5	3.25	2.5	2.25	3	2
Image quality (Combi, Best - Out of 5)							
Text print (B/W)	3.75	3	3.25	3.25	4	3.25	3.75
Resolution of circles on concentric pattern	3	2	3.25	3	3.25	2.75	3.25
White text on black background	3.25	4	2	2.25	2.75	2.5	2
Minimum readable text point size	3.25	3.25	3	3	3.25	3.25	2.25
Warranty Details							
Number of Years	2	2	1	3	3	3	3
Type (Onsite/Carry In)	Onsite	Onsite	Onsite	Onsite	Onsite	Carry In	Carry In
Number of Authorised Service Centres	130	130	34	165	165	190	100
Price	13.02	12.27	14.86	11.56	8.89	13.54	13.87
Price of Printer (Rs)	9995	11995	8999	11990	16990	9999	9990
Price of Toner (Rs)	3495	3495	3365	4499	4499	4200	3750
Rated Cost Per Page (Rs)	1.75	1.17	1.35	1.50	1.50	1.40	1.25
Overall Score (Out of 100)	60.36	57.50	60.27	53.37	53.85	47.05	51.28

In our combi-document test, we were surprised by the Samsung 2551N, which took a confusing 156 seconds to print in Normal mode and 160 seconds to print at Best quality. These figures made it lose out immensely.

The results suggest that in an environment where you need to only print text documents, you should opt for the WeP 2500, since it will print all your documents fast, and without compromising on anything visible in terms of quality.

Having finished with the speed tests, it was time for the quality tests...

In the text quality test, the Xerox reigned

supreme, followed by Brother's 6050D and 5140. The worst performer in this test was the Samsung 2551N.

In the 'white text on black background box' in our combi-document, the Brother 5170DN, WeP 2500 and Samsung ML2551N tied for the top honours, but sadly, were still nothing special.

Others, such as the Xerox Phaser 3420P, smudged the prints. All manufacturers, except Xerox and WeP, offered a 3-year on-site warranty.

In terms of economy, the Brother HL 6050D was the most economical with a cost of just 63 paise per page.